Assignment 3: Design Project (Sequence)

Component	Due	Weighting
a. Stand-up Presentation	Week 9 studio sessions	x4 — Team, assessed across a, b & c
b. Tradeshow	Week 12 studio sessions	
c. Artefacts (repo + PDF)	3pm Monday, Week 13	

Introduction

In teams, and building on your proposal, you'll turn your design opportunity into a proof-of-concept prototype and test it with real users, domain experts and other stakeholders — a web, mobile, embedded, tangible or other digital form suited to your domain. We are not asking you to solve a problem, but to take advantage of the possibilities of social and mobile/contextual computing to deliver a novel, compelling experience, tailored to a specific domain. This isn't about building a finished product; it's about running a full design cycle (research, requirements, design, build, evaluate, refine) to learn more about your users and problem space, and have the opportunity to build a novel, interactive, social/mobile experience; at least one meaningful round of user evaluation should be conducted before the final exhibit. You'll present the result at an end-of-semester interactive tradeshow (Week 12) with a poster and short pitch, and document the whole process — decisions, insights, setbacks and all — on GitHub, while also thinking through the ethical implications of what you're building. Your tradeshow will be a demonstration, not a presentation—allow visitors to your stall to interact with what you've built and deliver the intended user experience, and ask questions about your intent.

What You'll Deliver

- **Interactive prototype (Week 12 Studios)** — demonstrate social/mobile computing in your domain, in person, at the exhibit. It must support multiple users, since you're demonstrating a social and/or mobile experience.
- **Tradeshow promotional materials (Week 12 Studios)** — a self-contained conference-style poster explaining your domain, opportunity and solution, plus a 3-minute pitch to visitors. Short videos, brochures etc. are also encouraged.
- **Documentation (Week 13, Monday 3pm)** — your design process, research, user evaluations, source code, poster and promotional material, tracked in a public GitHub repository.

What to Do

1. Research (ongoing)

Your proposal research is the foundation — keep building on it with current literature. Focus now on your users: their needs and desires around your design opportunity. Draw on:

- Academic studies relevant to the problem
- Other published data — reports, statistics
- Primary data — interviews, focus groups, surveys
- Observations of the use context
- Other user-focused methods (e.g. probes)

Synthesise findings rather than reproducing full transcripts or literature reviews — quote sources to back up your claims, and use photos to show context. Aim to have most core research done by Week 9.

2. Requirements

From your evidence, define the problem/opportunity clearly and what your design needs to achieve. Document initial requirements by ~Week 8, and keep revisiting and refining them as research and evaluation continue.

3. Designs

Show how research became design: wireframes, mood boards, thumbnails, low-fidelity prototypes, sketches, scenarios, workflows — whatever suits your project. You don't need every artefact type; document what you produced and the decisions behind it.

4. Interactive Prototype(s)

Build enough functionality to demonstrate your core social/mobile concept — not a fully working product. Some parts can be simulated (video, animation, dummy content, existing APIs) where they're not central to your idea. Skip infrastructure that isn't core to the concept (e.g. don't build real login — everyone can be "Joe Bloggs" for the demo).

Someone outside your team should be able to use it unassisted. You might deliver one prototype mixing simulated and real interaction, or a small portfolio covering different aspects of the experience. Use a design framework (the *location framework* is recommended, or another suited to your domain) to guide your thinking about the social/mobile concepts involved — awareness, coordination, collaboration, synchronous/asynchronous interaction, location-awareness, and so on. Be ready to discuss the theory and methods behind your design choices.

5. Stand-up Week 9

The semester runs with a formative, identity-verified stand-up presentation in Week 9 to review progress and re-plan. Keep stand-ups short and focused; teaching staff will be present. Every team member speaks — what they did, what's next. Use your GitHub documentation to illustrate progress, flag issues/changes, and capture next steps afterwards.

By Week 9 you should be able to show: user research findings, a clear set of experience requirements, at least one early prototype, evaluation findings from testing with users (or proxies), and progress on the functional prototype. If any of this is missing, be ready to explain why.

Stand-up is formative and pass/fail — every member must attend and speak to their contribution.

6. GitHub Repository & Documentation

- **README.md** — guide to the repo, with links to key documentation and deploy/usage instructions (including any login details).
- **Prototype** — accessible from the repo root (or linked if hosted elsewhere), with usage instructions in the README.
- **Ongoing documentation** — evidence as you gather it: quotes, graphs, survey/interview findings, photos, sketches, wireframes. Use GitHub Projects to track tasks/issues rather than adding separate paperwork.
- **Stand-up records** — capture state, outcomes and next steps on the WIKI after each internal team stand-up (we expect teams to keep records of their internal stand-ups/meetings in addition to the Week 9 in-class assessment); write these up as you go so they double as your process documentation later.
- **Ethical considerations** — a dedicated WIKI page assessing the ethical risks/implications of your project, using an ethics framework (e.g. Loke & Matthews, 2020) or the Ethical Disclaimer canvas at ethicsfordesigners.com. You should be familiar with both.
- **Design process overview** — a WIKI page telling the top-level story of your design process: how the prototype came to be, what you tried, what changed, what you learned from user evaluations. Mix of writing and images/screenshots is fine — this isn't an essay.

Suggested outline for the Design Process Overview:

- Link to your poster & promotional material up front
- Link to the prototype + deploy/login instructions
- Summary — the problem/opportunity and how you addressed it
- Process — how you tackled it, with images/captions, evolution of ideas, limitations, relevant theory
- Who did what
- ~1,000 words plus images (references excluded, any consistent style, can link to additional supplementary documentation/appendices as needed)

7. Exhibit: Prototype(s), Poster & Promotional Material, in Week 12 Studio

Create an A2 (420mm × 594mm), portrait, close-read conference poster covering your problem space, concept and process — pulling from your GitHub documentation. Prepare a very short 2-3 minute oral pitch to go with it. Every team member needs to be prepared to pitch.

Optional extra promotional material (video, website, brochure, social media/#hashtag) should let your idea stand on its own when you're not there to explain it: focus on the problem and what's unique, show how the prototype works, avoid deep technical detail, and pick formats that suit your project. Link or embed all of this from your GitHub repo's main page.

Submission

What	When	Format
Stand-up WIKI page	Ahead of stand-up (Week 9)	Repo WIKI — captures project state and outcomes
GitHub repository URL	3pm Mon, Week 13	Must contain all documents/artefacts below; WIKI accessible to staff; link submitted to Blackboard
PDF export	3pm Mon, Week 13	Design Process Overview + Ethical Considerations WIKI pages. File name: TeamName_3DesignPrototype.pdf

How You'll Be Assessed

Graded against UQ's qualitative scale (7 = exceptional → 2 or below = unsatisfactory), across five equally-weighted criteria:

- An innovative project offering real insight into how social/mobile technology could work in your domain
- Prototypes that balance functionality and simulation to give meaningful interaction with the intended experience
- A creative, engaging pitch and poster that clearly explain the project
- Comprehensive, consistent documentation — methods, results and analysis of user research, task management, interim designs/prototypes, ethical considerations and other outputs
- A design process overview that clearly shows a user-centred process, backed by ethical consideration, critical research and creative outcomes

Proof-of-concept prototype = an advanced prototype balancing simulation and real functionality — users can meaningfully interact with the key parts of the concept, while still getting a sense of the whole.